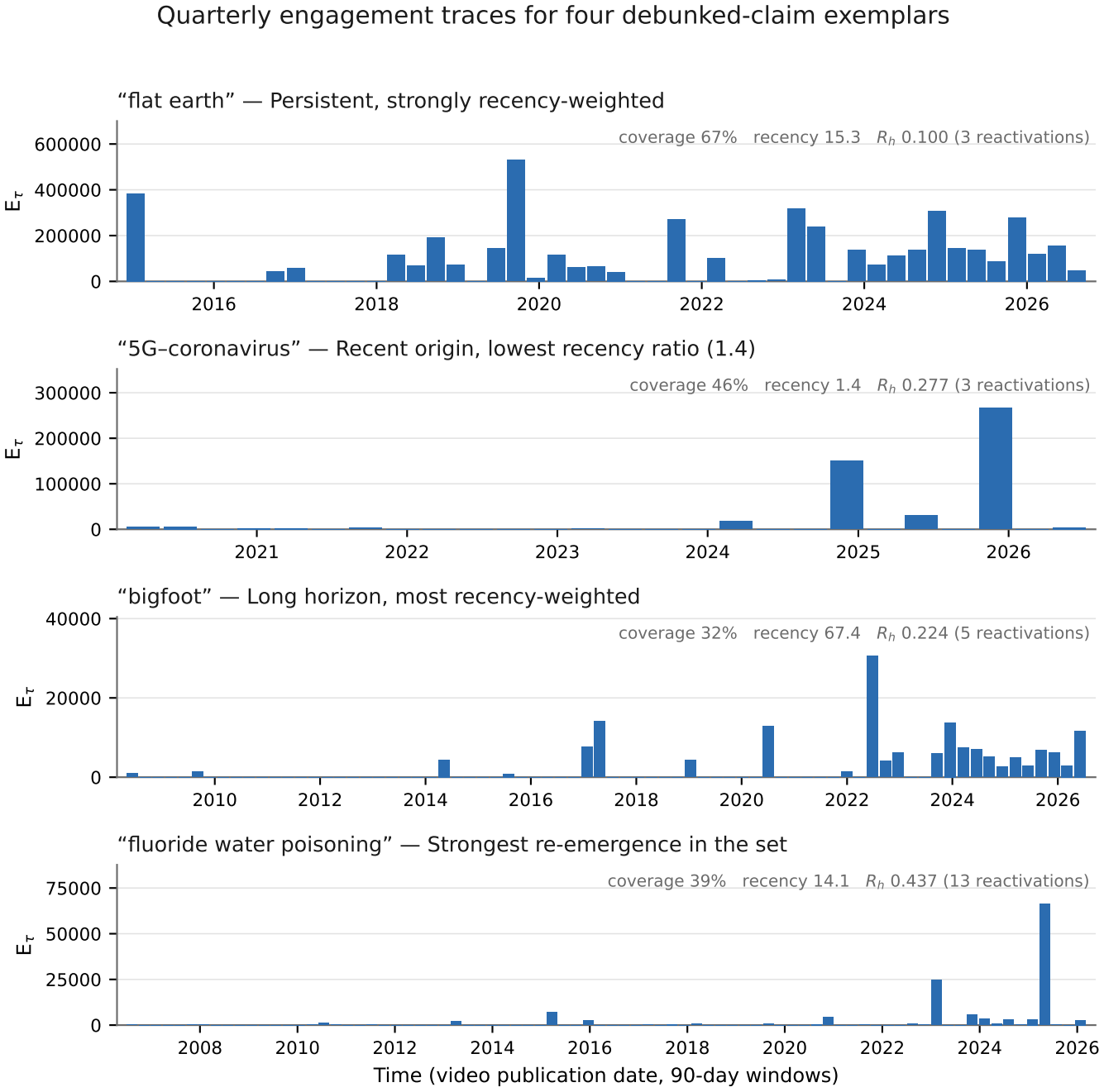
Quarterly engagement traces for four debunked-claim exemplars
“flat earth” — Persistent, strongly recency-weighted
coverage 67% recency 15.3 R_h 0.100 (3 reactivations)
E_τ
600000
400000
200000
0
2016
2018
2020
2022
2024
2026
“5G–coronavirus” — Recent origin, lowest recency ratio (1.4)
coverage 46% recency 1.4 R_h 0.277 (3 reactivations)
E_τ
300000
200000
100000
0
2021
2022
2023
2024
2025
2026
“bigfoot” — Long horizon, most recency-weighted
coverage 32% recency 67.4 R_h 0.224 (5 reactivations)
E_τ
40000
20000
0
2010
2012
2014
2016
2018
2020
2022
2024
2026
“fluoride water poisoning” — Strongest re-emergence in the set
coverage 39% recency 14.1 R_h 0.437 (13 reactivations)
E_τ
75000
50000
25000
0
2008
2010
2012
2014
2016
2018
2020
2022
2024
2026
Time (video publication date, 90-day windows)